

Prayers for our World and the Church

26th April 2026

John 8:32, 36

*Then you will know the truth, and the Truth will set you free...
So if the Son sets you free, you will be free indeed.*

Let us pray...

Thanks to God

O Lord, we thank You this weekend for Australia, which was formed because the people of the colonies agreed to unite as a nation by “humbly relying on the blessing of Almighty God”.

We thank You for Your mercies as our nation yesterday remembered those who have served in times of war. We pray for those who returned, wounded and battle-scarred, as well as those who did not return, but gave their lives to preserve the freedoms we enjoy today.

We thank You also for those who became prisoners of war, and we especially recall from within our own congregation Eric Edwards, captured at Tobruk in 1941. We remember and give You thanks for others connected with this congregation: Wally and Tom French, Jim Gleeson, and others who served in various theatres of conflict.

We thank You that, because of the sacrifice of so many, we were free to hear the good news of the gospel, and respond to the leading of the Holy Spirit. We acknowledge that we have been forgiven by Your grace and mercy alone. We thank You for setting us free indeed from sin – the greatest freedom we can know in this life.

The Church

We pray for Your church, the Body of Christ, and for the task You have entrusted to us, to be ambassadors for Jesus, declaring His victory at the Cross and in the Resurrection.

We pray for boldness, to declare the Truth that death is not the end, but that because Jesus lives, there is a sure hope – we can face tomorrow. We thank You that because sin has been judged and defeated, those we speak to can look to You for a hope and a future.

Ashburton

We pray for our work here at Ashburton, and give thanks for the Assessor Elders appointed by Presbytery. We pray for the Session to know Your wisdom as they minister to the needs of the congregation, that we may continue to grow in faith and in numbers as You bring new people to us. Strengthen us as we serve one another in love and good deeds.

We continue in prayer for Jan and all those involved in preparing for the memorial service. We thank You that Allan's passing to glory is an occasion for thanks, and not only for grieving at his absence from us.

We thank You for Your Word, and for Douglas as he preaches today. We pray that his words will bring true light to our understanding so that we may grow in godliness as a congregation, manifesting Your love to each other and to those beyond these four walls.

In His Precious Name we pray, Amen.

Before we come to our second reading for today, let us recite the words of the ANZAC memorial, and as we do, recall that the closing words are from a prayer to the Lord God of Hosts, a reminder that we are truly in God's hands, even as we remember the sacrifices of our armed forces.

They shall not grow old, as we that are left grow old.

Age shall not weary them, nor the years condemn.

At the going down of the sun, and in the morning,

We WILL remember them.

Lest We Forget

Lord God of Hosts, be with us yet, Lest we forget—lest we forget!

it is evident just what we are being reminded to remember; namely, the sacrifices of our soldiers, who died fighting an enemy on the other side of the world in order, we are told, to preserve our freedoms.

Then you will know the truth, and the Truth will set you free John 8:32

The people of the various colonies, ...humbly relying on the blessing of Almighty God, agreed to unite into a nation